

Silviya Nitsova

Department of Politics
University of Manchester
Manchester, M13 9PL, UK

✉ silviya.nitsova@manchester.ac.uk
🌐 www.snitsova.com
🔗 [Google Scholar](#)

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of Manchester, Manchester, UK
British Academy International Fellow, 2024-
Department of Politics
Research Associate,
Mitchell Centre for Social Network Analysis
Cathie Marsh Institute for Social Research

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC
Ph.D. in Political Science, May 2024
Comparative Politics, Political Methodology
Committee: Graeme Robertson (chair), Alexander Volfovsky (Duke), David Szakonyi (George Washington), Cameron Ballard-Rosa, Lucy Martin

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC
M.A. in Global Studies, 2017

Leiden University, Leiden, Netherlands
M.Sc. in Political Science, 2012
International Relations

Sofia University “St. Kliment Ohridski”, Sofia, Bulgaria
B.A. in European Studies, 2010

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political economy, comparative politics, business-government relations, elites, governance, political connections, political networks.

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

Nitsova, Silviya. Oligarchic Networks of Influence and Legislatures in Developing Democracies: Evidence from Ukraine. *Conditionally accepted at American Political Science Review (pending journal replication review).*

- Winner, Beth Holmgren Graduate Student Essay Prize, Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies, 2024.
- Winner, James W. Prothro Best Paper Award, UNC Political Science, 2024.
- Winner, Best Doctoral Paper Award, Association for the Study of Nationalities, 2023.
- Honorable mention, Lubomyr Hajda Graduate Student Paper Prize, American Association for Ukrainian Studies, 2024.

Nitsova, Silviya. 2021. [“Why the Difference? Donbas, Kharkiv and Dnipropetrovsk after Ukraine’s Euromaidan Revolution.”](#) *Europe-Asia Studies*, 73:10, 1832-1856.

BOOK PROJECT **Nitsova, Silviya.** Divide and Rule: Oligarchic Networks and Patronal Politics. *In development.*

WORKING PAPERS **Nitsova, Silviya.** War, Oligarchs, and the Conditional Legitimacy of Property Rights.

WORK IN PROGRESS **Nitsova, Silviya.** Oligarchs and Geopolitical Realignment.

Nitsova, Silviya and John Heathershaw. Oligarchs as Networked Actors: A Relational Conceptualization in Comparative and Global Perspective.

Nitsova, Silviya and Bilyana Petrova. How Do Attitudes towards Wealth and Economic Redistribution Vary across East European Democracies?

POLICY & OTHER PUBLICATIONS **Nitsova, Silviya.** [Ukraine’s oligarchs are united against Russia. That wasn’t the case in 2014.](#) Monkey Cage: Washington Post. April 5, 2022.

Conte, Simon, Graeme Robertson, Yuliya Shypilova, Kate Marple-Cantrell, Mariana Akyshina, **Silviya Nitsova**, and Kostiantyn Gieser. [Parliamentary Strengthening in Ukraine: A Field Assessment for Learning, Evaluation and Research Activity II \(LER II\)](#). USAID. March 2020. 96 pages. *Responsible for survey design and analysis.*

Nitsova, Silviya, Grigore Pop-Eleches, and Graeme Robertson. [Revolution and Reform in Ukraine: Evaluating Four Years of Reform.](#) PONARS Eurasia. July 2018. 70 pages.

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS	External Research and Academic Fellowships	
	British Academy International Fellowship, The British Academy	2024-2027
	<i>£331,285 (plus access to alumni follow-on funding, 2027-2032)</i>	
	Fellowship, Ronald Coase Institute	2025
	<i>\$2,500</i>	
	Graduate Sabbatical Grant, Institute for Humane Studies	2023
	<i>\$15,000</i>	
	World Politics & Statecraft Fellowship, Smith Richardson Foundation	2023
<i>\$7,500</i>		
Publication Accelerator Grant, Institute for Humane Studies	2023	
<i>\$5,000</i>		
Box-Steffensmeier Scholarship, Society for Political Methodology	2020	
<i>\$2,300</i>		

Rotary Peace Fellowship, The Rotary Foundation 2015-2017
\$47,200 (*plus tuition*)

Internal Research and Academic Fellowships

Summer Research Funding, UNC Political Science 2023
Research Award, UNC CSEES 2023
Graduate Tuition Incentive Scholarship, UNC Graduate School (x2) 2023
Chair's Top-Up Award, UNC Political Science 2022
Harold J. Glass USAF Fellowship, UNC Graduate School 2021-2022
Alumni Excellence Research Fellowship, UNC Political Science 2021
Summer Funding Award, UNC Political Science 2018-2021
Davie Circle Summer Research Fellowship, UNC Graduate School 2020
Uhlman Research Fellowship, UNC Political Science 2020
Summer Research Grant, UNC Global Studies 2016

Conference Travel Grants

UNC, APSA, SIOE, IHS, and others, *approx. \$11,200 total* 2022-2025

ACADEMIC VISITS & INVITED TALKS University of Gothenburg, QoG Institute. (visiting scholar) *Scheduled* 2026
University of Gothenburg, Comparative Politics/QoG Seminar. *Scheduled* 2026
LSE, Workshop on Wartime Political Behavior in Russia & Ukraine 2026
University of Manchester, Social Statistics Research Seminar. 2026
University of Glasgow, CEES Seminar. 2025
University of Oxford, RESC Politics Seminar. 2025
University of Manchester, Democracy & Elections Seminar. 2024
George Washington University, Contemp. Ukrainian Politics Workshop. 2024
UNC-Chapel Hill, Political Power and Persuasion Workshop. 2023
Hokkaido University, Slavic-Eurasian Research Center Symposium. 2023
Japanese Association of Ukrainian Studies. 2023
Copenhagen Business School, Department of International Economics, Government and Business. (online) 2022
National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine, 2021-2022
Institute of Political and Ethnic Studies. (visiting scholar)

CONFERENCES *Organizer (O), Paper presenter (P), Discussant (D), Award winner (A)*

APSA Annual Meeting: 2022 (P), 2023 (P, D), 2024 (P), 2025 (P, D)
MPSA Annual Conference: 2023 (P), 2024 (P, D)
EPSA Annual Conference: 2025 (P)
SIOE Annual Conference: 2025 (P), 2026 (P)
POLNET Annual Conference: 2026 (O, P)
POLMETH Europe Meeting: 2025 (P)
ASEES Annual Convention: 2023 (P, D), 2024 (A)
BASEES Annual Conference: 2026 (P)
ASN Annual Convention: 2023 (P, A)

BASU National Meeting: 2026 *Scheduled* (O, P)

SMALL	<i>Paper presenter (P), Discussant (D)</i>	
SPECIALIZED	Ronald Coase Institute Alumni Conference. Fontainebleau, France. (P)	2026
CONFERENCES &	Ronald Coase Institute Workshop. Perugia & Florence, Italy. (P, D)	2025
WORKSHOPS	WhoGov Workshop on Political Elites. University of Oslo. (P, D)	2025
	EPSA Pre-conference on Political Connections.	2025
	University Carlos III of Madrid. (P)	
	Early Career Workshop in Quantitative Political Economy.	2025
	King's College London. (P)	
	Data on Crime and Networks Workshop. University of Manchester. (P)	2025
	Political Economy Political Science Institutions (PEPSI) Launch	2024
	Conference. University of Essex. (D)	
	Danyliw Research Seminar. University of Ottawa. (P)	2024
	LSE-NYU Annual Conference in Political Science & Political Economy.	2024
	London School of Economics and Political Science. (P)	
	Women in Legislative Studies Annual Conference. Rice University. (P)	2022
	CBS Money in Politics Conference. Copenhagen Business School. (P, D)	2022
	14 th Annual Rotary Peace Center Conference. UNC-Chapel Hill. (P)	2017
FIELD RESEARCH & REGIONAL EXPERIENCE	Ukraine, 2016 (3 months), 2019 (2 months), 2021-2022 (6 months). Field research for Master's and PhD research. Formal and informal elite and non-elite interviews. Armenia (2013), Albania (2013), Ukraine (2014), Tajikistan (2015). Short-term election observer, OSCE/ODIHR.	
RESEARCH ASSISTANCE EXPERIENCE	University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill Research Assistant for Profs. Timothy Ryan and Lucy Martin, May-Aug 2023. Research Assistant for Prof. Graeme Robertson, 2016-2020.	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill <i>Instructor of Record</i> POLI 281 Data in Politics: An Introduction, Spring 2024, Spring 2021 (online). <i>Teaching Assistant</i> POLI 130 Introduction to Comparative Politics, Fall 2022, Spring 2020 (partially online), Fall 2019, Spring 2019, Fall 2018. Instructors: Profs. Rahsaan Maxwell, Ashley Anderson, Andrew Reynolds. Workshops and Guest Lectures Designing Empirical Research on Political Networks , half-day workshop (PhD students, ECRs, senior researchers), 19 th Annual Political Networks Conference, University of Manchester, Aug 5, 2026.	

Introduction to Social Network Analysis, guest lecture, Research Methods for the Social Sciences (BA, MA, PhD students), Central European University, Invisible University for Ukraine, Dec 12, 2024 (online).

Oligarchic Networks of Influence and Ukraine's Verkhovna Rada since the Euromaidan, guest lecture, Introduction to Public Policy (MA students), Kyiv School of Economics, Nov 13, 2024 (online).

OTHER
PROFESSIONAL
EXPERIENCE

Expert, Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Sofia, Bulgaria (2011-2015).
Trainee, European Commission, Brussels, Belgium (2013-2014).
Trainee, Council of Europe Office in Ukraine, Kyiv, Ukraine (2016).

PROFESSIONAL
DEVELOPMENT

Academic Advising Essentials Training

School of Social Sciences, University of Manchester, 2026

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods

Inter-University Consortium for Political and Social Research, University of Michigan, 2020 (online).

- Network Analysis: Advanced Topics;
- Advanced Bayesian Modeling;
- Data Science and Text Analysis.

METHODS
GRADUATE
COURSEWORK

Multilevel modeling, social network analysis, causal inference (regression discontinuity, instrumental variables, difference-in-differences), Bayesian statistics, game theory.

LANGUAGE &
TECHNICAL
SKILLS

Bulgarian (native), English (proficient), Russian (advanced), Ukrainian (intermediate).
Statistical computing in **R**, Python, Stata, Qualtrics, L^AT_EX.

SERVICE &
LEADERSHIP

Journal and Grant Review Service

Journal Reviewer, *American Political Science Review*, *American Journal of Political Science*, *Democratization*, *Government and Opposition*, *Post-Soviet Affairs*, *East European Politics*, *Europe-Asia Studies*, *Nationalities Papers*.
External Grant/Fellowship Reviewer, [The British Academy](#), [The Rotary Foundation](#), [ICLD Swedish International Centre for Local Democracy](#).

Conference and Association Leadership

Co-organizer, Program Committee Member, Workshop Lead, [19th Annual Political Networks Conference](#).

Co-organizer, Program Committee Member, [UoM Conference and 1st British Association for the Study of Ukraine National Meeting](#).

Co-chair, Early Career Researchers Working Group, [British Association for the Study of Ukraine](#).

Expert and Advisory Service

Expert, [Chapel Hill Expert Survey](#) (Bulgaria).

Expert, [Data for Ukraine](#).

REFERENCES

Graeme Robertson

Michael E. Taylor Dist. Professor
Department of Political Science
UNC-Chapel Hill
graeme@email.unc.edu

Alexander Volfovsky

Assoc. Prof. of Statistical Science
Department of Statistical Science
Duke University
alexander.volfovsky@duke.edu

David Szakonyi

Assoc. Prof. of Political Science
Department of Political Science
George Washington University
dszakonyi@gwu.edu

Olga Onuch

Professor of Comparative & Ukrainian Politics
Department of Politics
University of Manchester
olga.onuch@manchester.ac.uk